INCH-POUND

MIL-C-44467
23 February 1993

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN CHOW MEIN, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.2 Scope. This specification covers chicken chow mein, thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-C-44340(GL) - Can, Tray Pack

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Parts 301-399)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

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U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms

(Copies are available from the Chief, Process Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 0709, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS), U.S. FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, One Maritime Plaza, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 - Peel Adhesion of Pressure-sensitive Tape

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

AOAC INTERNATIONAL

Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC

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(Application for copies should be addressed to the AOAC International, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400-CD, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418).

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Water. Water used for ice-making, formulation, rehydration, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.2 Chicken. The chicken shall be prepared from chilled or frozen ready-to-cook fowl (mature female chicken) which has been processed in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. All chicken (raw or cooked) shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Poultry Product Grading Certificate to certify class and condition of the product and either the initial chilling date or initial freezing (in-storage) date.

3.2.2.1 Chicken, chilled. Raw bone-in or boneless chicken received in the chilled state shall not have been previously frozen and shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 40°F for a period of time not to exceed six days following initial chilling and prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3).

3.2.2.2 Chicken, frozen. Raw bone-in or boneless chicken received in the frozen state shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 0°F for a period of time not to exceed 120 days following initial freezing and prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3).

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3.2.2.3 Chicken, cooked, frozen. Frozen cooked chicken shall be prepared from chilled chicken that complies with 3.2.2 and 3.2.2.1. Chicken shall be processed in accordance with 3.3.1, and either 3.3.1.1 or 3.3.1.2. Cooked chicken, in either log or dice form, shall be packaged and sealed in USDA approved food packaging material and shall be frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or below within 72 hours. The packaged, frozen cooked chicken shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 120 days prior to tray pack filling (see 3.4). The initial freezing (in-storage) date and processing and packaging requirements shall be certified by a USDA Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) Poultry Products Agent.

3.2.2.3.1 Tempering/thawing. Tempering/thawing of frozen cooked chicken logs and dices shall comply with the following:

- microwave tempering/thawing of frozen chicken is permitted provided excellent condition of the chicken, as determined by the USDA, is maintained.

- the microwave tempering/thawing process shall not exceed 48 hours from the time of removal from the freezer to further preparation.

- regardless of the process used, frozen chicken shall be tempered/thawed to an internal temperature not to exceed 40°F (see 3.3.3 1/).

- when a tempering/thawing process other than microwave is used, the time from the start of the tempering/thawing process (removal from the freezer) to further preparation shall not exceed 96 hours.

- chicken which has been tempered/thawed shall not be refrozen.

3.2.3 Celery, fresh. Celery shall be fresh, crisp, white (blanched) or green variety. The celery shall be free from pithy branches, seed stems and damage.

3.2.4 Celery, dehydrated, sliced. The dehydrated celery slices shall be obtained from clean, sound Pascal type celery. The celery slices shall be approximately 3/8 inch cross-cut stalk slices with no leaf cuts. The dehydrated slices shall be free flowing and have a uniform bright color. The moisture content shall be not greater than 5.5 percent.

3.2.5 Bean sprouts, canned. The bean sprouts shall be prepared from the gold-colored seeds of the Mung Bean. The bean sprout shall be canned in water and shall be of the latest date of pack.

3.2.6 Mushrooms, canned, pieces and stems. The canned pieces and stems shall be U.S. Grade B or better, in accordance with the U.S. Standards for

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Grades of Canned Mushrooms. The mushrooms shall be drained prior to use in the sauce formulation. The mushrooms shall be of the latest date of pack.

3.2.7 Water chestnuts, sliced, canned. The canned sliced water chestnuts shall be packed in water. The color of the canned water chestnuts shall be white to off-white, and the slice thickness shall be 0.1 to 0.2 inches. The water chestnuts shall be of the latest date of pack.

3.2.8 Fat, chicken, rendered, frozen. Frozen rendered chicken fat shall have a clear, yellow color and a characteristic mild chicken-fat odor and flavor. The fat may contain USDA approved antioxidants. The chicken fat shall have a peroxide value not to exceed 6 meq./kg, a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.50 percent (expressed as oleic acid), and a moisture content not to exceed 0.25 percent. The chicken fat shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with USDA regulations and shall have been held at an internal temperature of $0^{\circ}F$ or lower for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to product formulation.

3.2.9 Starch, food, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified maize food starch for use in canned foods and shall comply with MIL-STD-900. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of $140^{\circ}F$ to $170^{\circ}F$ and be fully hydrated at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under stress, and under conditions of cold storage. The cooked slurry prepared from the starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste.

3.2.10 Soy sauce. The soy sauce shall have been prepared from water, wheat, soybeans, and salt. The soy sauce shall contain not more than 0.10 percent sodium benzoate as a preservative and shall have a titratable acidity of not less than 0.95 percent or more than 1.15 percent. The flavor shall be tart, sweet, salty, with a definite fermented bouquet. The soy sauce shall be a clear, reddish brown color with no visual impurities. The soy sauce shall be of the latest date of pack (see 6.4).

3.2.11 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, free flowing, white, refined sodium chloride, with or without anticaking agents, and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.12 Onions, dehydrated, chopped. Dehydrated chopped onions shall be Fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.13 Sugar, white, granulated. Sugar shall be white, refined, granulated cane or beet sugar, or a combination thereof, and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.14 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner coverings have been removed. The pepper shall have a

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characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot, biting pungent flavor, and a light color. The ground white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.15 Sodium tripolyphosphate. Sodium tripolyphosphate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Chicken preparation. The chicken shall be made boneless and skinless. The wing tips, giblets, neck, feet, and viscera shall be excluded. The boned meat shall be free of pin feathers, skin, blood clots, bruises, blemishes, ligaments, tendons, coarse connective tissue, and cartilage, and bone greater than 0.3 inch in any dimension. The boneless chicken meat shall be comprised of at least 50 percent white meat. Cooked chicken dices shall be prepared in accordance with 3.3.1.1 or 3.3.1.2.

3.3.1.1 Preparation of individually quick frozen (IQF) chicken dices. The IQF chicken dices shall be prepared as follows:

a. The chicken shall be cooked either before or after deboning by any commercially acceptable cooking method in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations.

b. The cooked chicken meat shall be cooled to an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F within four hours following the cooking process and shall be held not more than 48 hours at this temperature prior to dicing.

c. The cooked chicken meat shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch dimensions. The diced meat shall be held not longer than four hours at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F from time of dicing to the beginning of the IQF process (see 3.2.2.3).

3.3.1.2 Chicken log preparation and processing. The chicken logs shall be prepared and processed as follows:

Ingredient	Percent by Weight
Chicken meat	95.75
Ice or ice water	3.00
Salt	1.00
Sodium tripolyphosphate	0.25

a. Fresh chilled chicken meat processed on the day of boning shall be coarse ground within 24 hours following boning. If fresh-chilled (not previously frozen) chicken meat is transported between plants, it shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F and course ground within six days following boning. Frozen chicken meat shall be maintained at

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an internal temperature of 0°F or lower until further processing and be coarse ground within 120 days after boning. The meat shall be mechanically coarse ground through a grinder plate having kidney-shaped openings measuring not less than 2 inches in the shortest dimension. The grinder shall be equipped with a 2-blade knife.

b. The coarse ground (chunked) chicken meat shall be mechanically mixed with the ice or ice water, salt, and sodium tripolyphosphate. The mixing shall continue until the mixture exhibits a sticky (tacky) consistency. Time from grinding to mixing shall not exceed 4 hours. The ground chicken meat shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F during this time period.

c. The mixed chicken meat shall immediately be tightly stuffed into casings of a type and size to accommodate the cooking method and the finished product meat dimension requirement. Alternatively, the mixed meat may be formed in stainless steel molds to a size which will ensure compliance with finished product meat dimension requirements. The stuffed meat logs shall be in the cooking process within four hours after being stuffed. (This period of time may be extended up to 24 hours, provided the meat logs are maintained at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F.)

d. The chicken logs shall be cooked in a cook house (smoke house without smoke) or by other commercially acceptable cook methods to provide a product meeting the finished product drained weight and other requirements. Water cooking is permitted only for the meat logs in casings provided they are cooked in water until the internal temperature of the log reaches at least 160°F.

e. Immediately after completion of the cooking process, the cooked chicken logs shall be placed in an ice water bath, or cooled by other commercially acceptable rapid cooling methods. During cooling, the internal temperature of the chicken log shall not remain between 130°F and 80°F for more than 1.5 hours nor between 80°F and 40°F for more than 5 hours. The cooled logs shall be held for not more than 48 hours at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F prior to dicing or packaging for frozen storage (see 3.2.2.3).

f. The cooked chicken logs shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch dimensions. The diced meat shall be held not longer than 4 hours in the temperature range of 28°F to 40°F until preparation of the finished product or, if stored in frozen form, until packaged and vacuum-sealed (see 3.2.2.3).

3.3.2 Preparation of fresh celery. The fresh celery shall be cleaned thoroughly, trimmed to remove fibrous longitudinal strands and sliced in 3/8 inch cross-cut stalk slices with no leaf cuts. The sliced celery shall be blanched in 180°F to 190°F water for one minute. The blanched celery

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shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled drained celery shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and filled into the tray pack can within four hours after blanching.

3.3.3 Product formulation and preparation. The product shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

Ingredient	Percent by Weight
Water	30.86
Chicken, cooked, diced 1/	28.00
Celery, fresh, blanched or dehydrated 2/	14.13
Bean sprouts, drained	7.00
Mushrooms, drained	6.00
Water chestnuts, drained	6.00
Chicken fat	2.40
Starch, food, modified, high opacity	2.25
Soy sauce	1.50
Salt 3/	0.85
Onions, dehydrated, chopped	0.50
Sugar, white, granulated	0.44
Pepper, white, ground	0.07

1/ An alternative procedure to tempering/thawing of diced chicken meat may be as follows:

a. Diced chicken meat with an internal temperature of 0° to 40°F shall be blanched in a blancher basket with 1/4 inch holes.

b. The dices shall be blanched for not more than three minutes at a water temperature of 150° to 160°F with air agitation.

c. The blanched dices shall be thoroughly drained.

d. Blanching to product preparation shall be a continuous process.

2/ When dehydrated celery is used, 2.33 percent by weight of dehydrated celery and 42.66 percent by weight of water shall be used in the formula.

3/ The total amount of salt in the product formula shall be adjusted as necessary to comply with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.6).

NOTE: The following product preparation procedures were used in the development of this product. Alternate procedures may be used provided finished product requirements are met. (When alternate procedures are used, the time and temperature requirements specified for the prepared product are still applicable).

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a. A slurry shall be made using part of the formula water and the starch.

b. The chicken fat shall be combined with the remaining water and the mixture heated until the fat is completely dissolved.

c. The remaining ingredients (except the chicken) shall be added to the mixture and the mixture heated to 180°F to 190°F.

d. The slurry shall be added and the final mixture heated to 180°F to 190°F and held in this temperature range for five minutes.

e. The chicken shall be added and mixed only to the extent necessary to assure a uniform mixture of ingredients.

f. The product shall be maintained in the temperature range of 150°F to 180°F and shall be filled into the tray pack cans within four hours after preparation. When the temperature range of 150°F to 180°F cannot be properly maintained, the product shall be filled and sealed into tray pack cans and shall be in the retort process within two hours after preparation.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Immediately after filling, each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to assure compliance with the finished product requirement (see 3.6).

b. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within two hours after sealing.

3.5. Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

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d. No individual can shall contain a bone piece measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

e. There shall be no feathers or feather parts.

f. The total weight of skin, cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and discolored meat, collectively, in a can shall be not greater than 1 ounce.

g. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

h. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

i. The lot average drained weight of chicken pieces and vegetable pieces shall be not less than 58.0 ounces.

j. No individual can shall contain less than 56.0 ounces of drained chicken pieces and vegetable pieces combined.

k. Of the 56.0 ounces drained weight of product, not less than 10.0 ounces shall be whole intact chicken pieces.

l. Texture of chicken pieces shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

m. Texture of vegetables shall not be mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough.

n. Sauce consistency shall be smooth, without lumps, and shall not be excessively thick or thin.

o. The chicken pieces and vegetables shall be uniformly distributed.

p. The product shall not show evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

q. The fat content of any individual tray pack shall be not greater than 7.0 percent.

r. The average fat content shall be not greater than 5.0 percent.

s. The salt content of any individual tray pack shall be not greater than 1.3 percent and not less than 0.5 percent.

t. Filled, sealed and retorted cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

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3.7 Plant qualifications. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4)
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5)

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material examination. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be examined in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each

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ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Net weight examination. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Double sampling plan for product examination. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in table I utilizing the double sampling plans indicated in MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be expressed in tray pack cans. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed tray pack can. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0 for major defects. The sample cans shall be heated in accordance with the heating instructions on the can label.

TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Presence of a bone piece measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension
102	Presence of feathers or feather parts

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TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	
103	Total weight of skin, cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and discolored meat, collectively, is greater than 1 ounce
104	Drained weight of chicken pieces and vegetable pieces in a can is less than 56.0 ounces 3/ 4/
105	Of the 56.0 ounces drained weight of product, less than 10.0 ounces are whole intact chicken pieces 5/
106	Texture of chicken pieces dry, rubbery or mushy 6/
107	Texture of vegetables mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough 6/
108	Sauce consistency lumpy or is excessively thick or thin
109	Chicken pieces and vegetables not uniformly distributed
110	Product shows evidence of excess heating (materially darkened or scorched)

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, metal) foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, moldy), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

3/ To determine drained weight, the free liquid in the can shall be poured off and the remaining contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 180°F to 190°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be gently agitated such as to liquify rendered fat and to remove the sauce without breaking the chicken

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pieces or vegetables. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard No. 7 sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the chicken pieces or vegetables. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at an approximate 45° angle and allowed to drain for two minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4/ The lot shall be rejected if the average drained weight of the chicken pieces and vegetable pieces is less than 58.0 ounces.

5/ For the purpose of this examination, the definition of a whole intact chicken piece is one that measures not less than 3/8 inch in each of two separate dimensions.

6/ Examination for appearance and texture conformance of the chicken and vegetable pieces shall be made of representative pieces immediately following the determination of drained weight.

4.5.3.3 Fat and salt content testing. Three filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be individually tested for fat content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, methods 960.39, 976.21, or 985.15, and for salt content in accordance with method 935.47, except that the preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The unopened tray pack cans shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat and salt requirement in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that the inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with 4.5.4.1. In addition, scratches, scuffs, or abrasions that occur on the outside coating as a result of the filling, sealing, and thermoprocessing of the tray cans shall not be scored as a defect.

4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4), except, for self-adhering labels, the following additional defects shall apply:

Major: Label torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can, for example, label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.

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4.5.4.2 Label adhesive examination. When self-adhering labels are used, the adhesive shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 3330.

4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closures shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer's requirement and 21 CFR, Part 113, Subpart D, or 9 CFR, Part 318, Subpart G, as applicable. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or on record of can seam teardowns shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to 75°F ± 5°F, held for at least 24 hours after sealing, and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside edge of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the strength edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. When examining a ribbed lid, lay the straight edge only between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconformance shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard line or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.5.8 Unit load examination. Examination of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A.

5.1.1 Level A. One hundred and six ounces of food product shall be filled into a tray pack can conforming to MIL-C-44340 and sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5.

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5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with a HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1) except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of class domestic, grade 175 fiberboard.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3 shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard

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or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (for example, EST 38) or a three-digit letter code identifying the establishment.
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/
- Retort cook number 1/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four-digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year. (Example, March 19, 1987 would be coded as 7078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sublotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four-digit Julian code. Following the four-digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above. In addition, the name of the product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 100 by 200 end of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.5.4 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT IN WATER: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 40 to 45 minutes. Avoid overheating (can shows evidence of bulging).

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

TO HEAT IN OVEN: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place. Place in a 350°F oven 35 to 40 minutes.

WARNING: Do not place unopened can in oven. This may cause the can to burst.

YIELD: Serves 18 portions of 2/3 cup each.

As an alternative labeling method, a preprinted, self-adhering, 0.002-inch thick, clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive

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adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. When self-adhering labels are used, the tray pack cans shall be labeled with the Julian code and a product code prior to retorting.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE, UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
e. Level of packing required (see 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item

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being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MC 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.4 Ingredient information.

6.4.1 Soy sauce. It has been found that soy sauce, Product Code 00610, manufactured by Kikkoman International, meets the requirements of 3.2.10 and performed satisfactorily in the development of this product. The 1.50 percent by weight of soy sauce in the formula was based on the titratable acidity requirements specified in 3.2.10. The tray pack chicken chow mein producer is cautioned to verify the titratable acidity requirement prior to product formulation.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned food
Combat field feeding
Food processing
Operational rations
Poultry
Shelf stable

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

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